

Pathwork Guide Lecture No. 250
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THE MEANING OF GRACE; RELEASING FAITH; LIVING ON DEFICIT

Greetings and blessings, my very beloved friends. The joy of seeing your community develop and expand is enormous. We praise the Lord for this wondrous fact that springs from your personal growth, from your commitments and devotion to serve a cause that goes way beyond your earth self.

Now I wish to speak about the meaning of grace. This is a difficult concept to comprehend for many of you. In former times grace was much more acceptable in that it was understood as a special dispensation from God that was given or not given for His own reasons. The individual had little to do with it. At a time when self-responsibility was little developed, grace was interpreted in this manner and therefore easier to accept.

In today's time at the present general state of mankind's development, self-responsibility is much more developed. You understand that you create your reality and your experiences -- good or bad. How then does grace come in? Is it totally eliminated from the scope of man's vision of life and reality? No, it is not. Grace is as much a reality as self-creation and self-responsibility. And they are by no means mutually exclusive. I wish to give you some outlook about this important subject, which will then open up another topic equally important -- that of faith.

The grace of God is. It exists at all times, penetrating all that is. It exists in the very nature of ultimate reality, which is thoroughly benign. Grace lies in the fact that all must work for the best, no matter how evil, how painful, how tragic it may appear at the moment. In the end, when these negative experiences are fully assimilated and lived through, they come around full circle to the light of love, truth, joy, peace, pleasure supreme, eternal life, well-being in all respects. This must always be the ultimate reality and therein lies the grace.

So truly you cannot help it to live in the grace of God. The very air you breathe is permeated with it. Every substance of life, on all levels from the finest vibrations and radiations to the crudest of matter is permeated with it. The very world you live in, the universe, all of creation, the way divine law is constructed, all are an expression of divine grace. You live and move and have your being in a universe that consists of such tenderness, such love, such personal care of the living God, the all eternal presence in all that is, that it simply defies description. You are surrounded by a universe in which there is simply nothing ever to fear -- no matter what momentary appearances may be!

The problem is not that you need to draw the grace of God to you. For it is already there, filling every pore of your being. The problem is your lack of vision, your limited view, your distorted interpretations, your faulty outlook, your personal blocks. These seem iron walls that enclose you and prevent you from perceiving and experiencing grace. In reality they are just a vapor

that must immediately dissolve once you rearrange your field of vision and therefore begin to dissolve your personality defects and blocks. As always, this process begins with the small everyday events and happenings. The gauge is right at your disposal. As I so often said to you, you can easily tell whether you are in truth or not by the way you feel. If you are in harmony with life, if you are joyous and hopeful, you can be certain that you partake of God's grace that surrounds and infills you -- in short, certain that you are in truth, at least in the limited way of your present state of consciousness as regards your immediate experiences and reactions to the world around you.

But when the opposite occurs, when you are in a state of disturbance, fear, and disharmony with yourself, others, and life in general, you forget this key I have given so often. I wish you would all choose to remember it. Impregnate yourself with it in your daily meditations. When you are unhappy, fearful, discouraged, in darkness, know at least that you are not in truth. This will make a lot of difference. Know that your blocks, your faulty vision, have separated you from the grace of God in which you swim, even now, although you do not know it.

Man's entire bent of putting effect before cause creates such misperceptions and misinterpretations of life that this in itself prevents you from experiencing grace. The habit of automatically concluding this reversed way extends to a great deal and to many different issues and aspects of reality. One example is the assumption that experiencing God's grace is something given you, or that feeling faith is something that comes from outside, as it were, something added on to you, while at the present time you lack it. You neither lack grace nor faith. As all else, it already exists in you. If only you could begin to think of yourself in these terms, all would fall into place so much easier. You somehow know the theory, but your habitual thinking does not go along these lines. You think of yourself as an empty vessel that needs to be filled from outside, as it were. Becoming implies acquiring something that you do not already possess. But in reality you are already all that you could ever wish to be. You already possess the states of consciousness you aim to attain. It is simply that only a limited part of your total self functions on this reality level of the world into which you were born. It is your task to gradually release those parts of you that fully exist on another level of reality, but need to be brought into this material level. The lower self exists precisely because of the limitation with which you manifest on this level of reality. Expansion, growth, development -- all these terms mean only one thing: to bring forth the perfection that you already are in essence. If you could think of this process more in terms of releasing what is already there, rather than of becoming something that you are not, that is still foreign to you, you would aid your own process considerably.

So you can release your intrinsic awareness of grace. You can release the faith that is already in you: that is, the knowledge that you live in a tender universe shaped out of personal love and caring, that there is nothing to fear. If you visualize in this way, you will release new awareness, new knowledge, new faith, new ways of reacting that will surprise you and fill you with wonder and joy.

What are the obstacles to releasing this faith, this knowledge, this awareness already existing within you? First of all, it is not knowing that you possess this awareness, this faith. The knowledge must be cultivated to begin in your outer brain and thinking material. Just considering the possibility that there is nothing to fear, that you live in an utterly benign universe, that you are filled with the living God, will make you automatically challenge your fears, doubts, distrust, and negative beliefs. This, in turn, will make it much easier for you to sufficiently trust life and its laws so that you will risk giving. And this is indeed an important lever that touches an inexorable law of life. For only as

you give out from yourself, from and with your heart, can you truly receive. You have heard this law discussed many times, in all religious scriptures that ever existed. It is such an important law. Yet it is usually misunderstood, or at least slightly, but sufficiently distorted so that it is put aside and not taken in by human beings. It is experienced as a sanctimonious edict, issued forth by an arbitrary authority that makes demands and then possibly rewards by giving in return, in a form of bargaining. Human dignity resists this concept, this attitude, and distrusts a universe that is pedagogic and treats the individual as if it were an unruly child. Although man's lower self often is indeed just that, as you well know, it is surely not the true personality, the real being.

Now, then, what does this law mean in reality? Every human being contains a built-in mechanism that makes receiving quite impossible when the soul holds in its innate capacity and yearning to give. Since in reality giving and receiving are one and the same flow, movement, and phenomenon; the one cannot exist without the other. Where distrustful, fearful holding back makes it impossible for the soul to enter into the flow of universal life and movement, the total mechanism is stopped, so that the grace of God with all its manifestations cannot enter into the consciousness of the personality. It is as though all the riches are there, ready to be tasted and experienced, but the hand cannot reach for them; the senses cannot perceive them; the eyes cannot see them; the brain cannot even observe their stark reality. It is as though the whole personality were dulled with all its perceptions, so that a totally distorted vision of life comes into focus. The illusion grows that you live in a poor, empty universe, and along with that, that your inner universe is equally poor and empty, that you have nothing to give from within and nothing to receive from without.

As you know, every attitude, every mental and emotional condition creates chain reactions and circles -- either benign or vicious ones, according to whether the belief, attitude, and behavior pattern is according to truth or error. When the illusion exists that the outer and inner universe is empty and impoverished, you automatically create a vicious circle. This belief must make you hoard yourself, your innate riches, talents, everything you possess spiritually or materially or both. Hence you separate yourself from the riches that surround and penetrate you. This inner mechanism makes your receiving impossible, which then increases and finally seems to confirm the vision of poverty of life and self.

In contrast, the benign circle can be established by risking to give out in the conscious expectation that possibly the fear of suspecting poverty and deprivation may be illusions and that abundance will grow. The more you thus start giving to God in trust and with love, the more you release further faith, and the more you liberate your bound vision. You will not only see the abundance flooding through you and surrounding you, you will also lift the lever that locked the mechanism. You will reach out into this rich world and allow it to bestow upon you all that it contains in such overpowering abundance, with such overpowering love of the Creator for you that words can never describe this magnificence. You enter more and more into a benign circle in which you can release more of your inner and outer riches because you know they are eternally and inexorably replaced as a never ending stream. So the more you receive, the more you can give, and the more you give, the more are you capable of receiving. It is then that giving and receiving become one.

So the first step must be to risk giving out -- to contemplate that your fear that makes you hold and hoard is erroneous. You test once again a new ground rule of life and begin gradually to discard an old one that has proven detrimental because it is false, because it paints a false picture of

life. False pictures are as reinforced by believing in them as true pictures are. That is the trouble with them. Only when they are being challenged will they lose their energy. This process can be likened to pulling out poisonous weeds and planting new beautiful seeds. Giving in faith, love, and trust in God, even before you are being convinced of its truth and reality, is planting your new, abundant, rich, beautiful spiritual garden. And when I say spiritual, I do not mean something far away, vague, and realizable in an afterlife. I mean something tangible that must sooner or later manifest in your material life here and now, with inner and outer riches.

And now I come to yet another obstacle in establishing this benign circle in which you flow in harmony with creation and live in the divine order and in divine grace. This obstacle is very important and seldom recognized for what it is. It exists on all levels, on inner, emotional, psychological, spiritual, and personal levels, as well as on outer, general, universal, collective levels. This topic is chosen again at this time to not only help you personally in the growth and process of your individual paths, but also to help you establish the new model of world government within your ever growing community. This obstacle is a tendency in human nature to build on deficit. This is of course intrinsically connected with the belief in an empty, poor, ungiving universe. Let me now be more explicit about what I mean by that. At first I speak about the personal, inner levels: When you attempt to build positive beliefs and life patterns on top of unconscious or semi-conscious negative beliefs, you build on deficit. When you secretly believe you are a totally unlovable and unacceptable human being, you build on deficit. When your real and false guilts prevent you from turning yourself fully over to God, you build on deficit. When you assume the universe to be hostile to you, and you protect yourself against this alleged hostility with destructive defenses (that you may or may not be conscious of, that you may rationalize and justify), you build on deficit.

Building on deficit can apparently succeed for a while. That is the trouble. Again, what is false seems to work for a while and thus becomes temporarily convincing. He who builds a house on unsafe, sandy ground may indeed erect a lovely looking structure that holds up for a while. When it begins to crumble, the builder may have shut off his awareness of having chosen to build on such a foundation and thus cannot see the connection. The crumbling of the house may be ascribed to different causes, which only maintains the illusion of life and the patterns of building on deficit.

The tools I have given you to work on your path are clearly designed to bring your deficits to the surface of your consciousness instead of denying that they exist or glossing over them as if they were not important. This path is directly designed to create an inner order, painful as this may be at first, so that you can then begin to build on real assets and never allow your inner "economics" to become fraudulent and unsound. The temporary pain of exposing your debts, your deficits is entirely based on the false world picture that, by doing so, you are doomed to accept "the reality of poverty." For you cannot trust that your unsound managing can be changed, that you can indeed create real riches based on a healthy policy. You are constantly running on deficit, always giving out in a distorted way, that has nothing to do with genuine giving. It is pretense giving in more ways than one. For example, you either project your mask self to the world while you inwardly despair about who you believe you really are (deficit). Or you give out in order to accrue what you do not deserve, in a manipulating way. This lower self "giving" is another manifestation of building on deficit. These false ways of giving may again temporarily work on the surface, but inwardly your deficits increase, and the impoverishment thus created is usually covered up more in order to avoid

the necessary bankruptcy that you have created. You grab outer, temporary, unsound means to coast along on pretense, in the illusion that you can go on indefinitely in this way.

Thus you build a mask illusion (that this way of operating with yourself can go on forever) on a lower self illusion (that the world is mean and poor). To put it differently, you only believe in the illusory wealth acquired through scheming, pretense, and greed, and not in the real wealth of God's creation. Practically this manifests in putting so much energy in your mask and lower self that you never want to dare exposing your deficits and the inner bankruptcy that often exists smoldering underground. When you work with your helpers and peers and bring all your guilts, all your lower self machinations to the fore, you stand there poor. You no longer cover up with a false veneer. You no longer try to avoid this poverty you have unwittingly created through false beliefs by destructive means that only increase the deficit. Fear and resistance to declare the bankruptcy that you have frantically covered up is finally overcome through faith. It is then that you can begin to create a sound new order of your inner wealth that has waited for this moment to manifest and enrich you.

All personal crises, all breakdowns are nothing but the bankruptcy being exposed. Often this crisis is deliberately induced under controlled circumstances -- when you work with your helpers, in your groups. You go through the shame of showing your deficits, you finally desist building on them, you sail through the fear and pain of believing that this is your final reality. But soon you discover the real wealth "behind" the frantic efforts to hide the assumed, and finally self created, poverty by pretending a false wealth built on deficit.

Your spiritual and emotional "finances" only too often also manifest on the material level. Hence it is often the case that people live above their means; they coast on debts; they cover one hole with another newly created hole. Although they live in a constant climate of anxiety, they refuse to create order because (1) they do not believe that order and abundance can exist for them, and (2) they are unwilling to give. Perhaps they do not want to give by paying the necessary price, which may be working, giving in their work, giving their best. Thus, they cannot make a decent livelihood, and they depend on others and accrue debts. The inner process of your pathwork sometimes, although not always, finally reaches the outer levels of material manifestations. On your path you have created budget sessions for those who have manifested the inner deficit on the outer level. In that way, you create a new, sound order in which you no longer run on and on on deficit. It is an exact replica of the inner pathwork you do on psychological and spiritual levels.

My beloved friends, this is extremely important for you to understand. It is important to see that finances, economics, collective governmental means follow the exact same patterns. They are sound, which means government is built on assets, not on deficit; on reserves, not on debts; on fullness, not on emptiness. For those of you who have some knowledge of the way governments, national and international, run, it will be easy to see how this principle I speak about here applies to the outer, collective levels as much as to the inner personal ones. Whenever a country has gone through severe crisis -- revolution, war, collapse, financial crashes -- it was a result of waiting too long to establish voluntarily (deliberate choice of working in controlled circumstances) cleanliness, order, truth, exposing the deficits, so that true abundance could then follow suit. This involuntary crisis can be likened to a breakdown of a person who individually refuses to expose the inner poverty, pretense, and deficit.

When governments live predominantly on injustice, greed, power drive; when they scheme and lie to deceive the populace, they always create not only a spiritual deficit but inevitably also a material one. The thus established imbalances can be covered up only so long. Eventually it must all surface so that a new order can be established. When countries go through such crises, they are often at first motivated by the best intentions. They create new laws and modalities, new collective measures and forms of governments. But when the inner meaning gets lost again, the same deficit, through different means, will arise. The forces of darkness could again distort the truth and tempt man away from the inner truth of God. Again his vision will be blurred, so that deficits accrue again. So the solution never lies in what form of government you adopt, what outer measures to institute, although admittedly some measures are better than others at different times.

If you look very closely at various governments in this world, with sufficient information, you will soon see where and how deficits are being created. Sometimes the direct, material deficits are obvious in a particular country's economics. It is clear that the government avoids the temporary exposure by frantically coasting along and covering one hole with another in pretense and never daring to trust that real wealth can be established. The crisis of admitting the imbalance and mismanagement is too frightening. Insufficient faith exists and the false world picture of a poor, untrustworthy, empty universe makes this step impossible.

This step is possible only when totally going to, through, in, and with God. Risking to have faith can create faith and the experience that it is justified to have faith. It is therefore foolish to assume that a balanced, harmonious, abundant world order can be established in which justice and peace can exist without a direct communication with the divine world and the Christ within and around you. If you ignore His existence, you cannot perceive His presence; nor can you hear His guidance, advice, and loving inspirations; nor feel the courage you need in order to go through the temporary exposure of inner bankruptcy (often also outer in individuals and countries). The shambles can be collected and rebuilt in a better way only when all participants are seriously filled with the purest of motives and directly ask God's eternal presence to help and inspire. This is the hope of the world in which you live. All else, everything that is undertaken without God, no matter how intelligent and efficient it may seem at first, is bound to fail in the long run. Only through and with God can the courage and honesty exist to trust total openness, and rebuilding can then begin in earnest and in glory. Only then will all governments run on assets. Only then can they function healthily with a constant balanced flow of giving and receiving, never exhausting the reserves because all is based on truth, justice, and fairness. One country will not deny the other its resources, so that mutual pressure and power plays will not have to corrupt the world that was created by God so that all can partake in everything, no matter where it exists. Why do you think God has put some resources in certain parts of the world only and others into other parts? The Creator disposes with the deepest of reasons and meanings. Never is anything just so because of accident. The reason is to help people to share and consider all other people which will enable them to also freely receive from them -- what they need and what others have. Right here you can see how a spiritual law works on the most practical of levels. Giving and receiving can exist when countries share their resources rather than hoarding them and using them in order to gain more power and riches regardless of how many people will be deprived.

My beloved friends, it is these principles that you need to establish in your community. In that way you will become a true model. Let me now say a few words about this process and give you some guidelines whose details you need to work out yourself. You need to make yourself a

channel for God's will in every detail. But some outer guidelines are necessary. The beginning has been made in a question I have been asked recently that very much deals with this topic. You have become aware of a certain imbalance within your structure. Balances constantly change, from one side that overweighs, to the other. In the development of an individual, as well as that of a collective organism, balances need to be constantly reexamined and changed in order to establish inner and outer harmony, health and honestly acquired wealth -- that is, divine abundance.

The following are some specific guidelines. You need to examine when the individual needs to give more to the collective entity and when the process can be reversed, and the collective entity can give more to the individual. You must never live above your means so that you function out of fullness and do not run on deficit. This should not be done in a spirit of anxiety and lack of trust. It is possible to have faith and yet not use misapplied faith in order to justify the current tendency in your world to function on deficit. At the same time, you need to establish priorities in a deep way. There may be temporary occasions when a deficit on the material level may be unavoidable until a sound basis of fullness and functioning on assets is being established. If you keep this goal in mind, you will attain it. In order to do so it may be necessary to keep your budget smaller than you may wish; it may mean that you, as a community, may have to do temporarily without something you may like to think of as essential until you can truly afford it. You may have to reconsider what is and what is not essential, and look at it from the point of view of the work that is being done and with a view of the task that is being fulfilled on a larger scale. Temporarily, more of you may have to pitch in with your giving, as some have done so from the very beginning. Without this, there would not have been this community as it exists today. The law fulfilled itself clearly in that none have come to deprivation from this giving; quite the contrary, more abundance has accrued for them. When more of you adopt this spirit, more abundance will be created for these same individuals and for the collective entity until the latter will be sufficiently healthy on all levels, including the material one, that it can give more and more to the individuals in question. But do not ever forget, even when this spiritual and material health and abundance is firmly rooted, each new person who desires to commit himself or herself to stage four -- that is, stage three in terms of giving nurturance -- needs to go through a period of giving without much recompense. If this step is being skipped, the spiritual health of the community would begin to suffer, which would eventually also effect the material health.

With this new outlook, a lot will change and you will lose completely that slight and nagging anxiety that still exists to some degree because there is still a groping in the dark as regards establishing an economy that functions on assets rather than on deficit. You must understand that this duplicates exactly the inner process of the path, but if the concept and vision is lacking, you may not express the outer picture in the same speed as the inner order already exists. So, often a problem needs to be tackled in the tunnel fashion: from both sides. You need to deepen your inner work on the spiritual and psychological level and purify all that which runs on deficit. At the same time, you need to also realize a similar process in your financial affairs personally (budget sessions are an integral part of this aspect). And, last but not least, the same principles need to be established for the material affairs of the collective entity. This is then true harmony, and your entire path, in all its workings, will function smoothly and richly. You will have more abundance that is well earned, honestly deserved, and can thus be guiltlessly enjoyed. This abundance will benefit many and, among other things, also make it possible for those who need to be materially sustained at the beginning, to be given scholarships until they become self-sustaining.

This lecture goes, of course, way beyond the factual advice at the end of it. You need to deeply understand a divine law and principle. You need to recognize all obstructions that prevent you from perceiving and partaking of the ever present divine grace so that you can release the faith that is realistic and more an experience of what is, rather than a belief in and a hope for what one might wish to believe. Often this latter attitude is assumed to be faith and actually shunned because of the fear of being unrealistic and then disappointed.

My dearest ones, Christ's embrace enfolds all of you and accompanies you in all your doings and in all your thinking. You are blessed.

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